Miles Thompson · NimbleCo · Wellington · utunga@gmail.com · 021 539 843

[Date]

[Name, Role]
[Company]
[City]

[Cc: names, if any]

Re: Proposal to set up a local, open agent harness at [Company]

Kia ora [Name],

I'm writing to see if [Company] would be interested in having NimbleCo set up an open-source agent harness on your own hardware, owned and run by your team. In the last year I've learned a lot about AI coding, agent harnesses and agentic governance, and teamed up with NimbleCo, who wrote one. I think we could get you started cheaply, pass on what we've learned, and then get out of the way so your team can experiment.

Apologies if this is stating the obvious, but by "agentic AI" I mean the following:

- *LLMs* can answer questions but you have to load everything into context and do the work yourself. They're like a chat window to a brain in a jar.
- *Agents*, by contrast, have hands. They do the work themselves: they read only the code they need, run tools (unit tests, small Python scripts, bash, ffmpeg, dvc) and, in practice, do a lot of grep, much as we use the search box in VS Code. They work to a project goal and coding standards, keep a memory of what they've learned and who is who, build 'skills' for repeatable tasks, and can run on a schedule or trigger without being prompted.

Turning an LLM into an agent requires an 'agent harness'. It adds a container for tool use, memory, scheduling, per-agent system prompts, skills and MCP connections, plus 'surfaces' such as Slack, GitHub issues or a coding IDE where you talk to the agent. One open-source, multi-agent harness is Swarm Map (links below), built by NimbleCo on Hermes, with a focus on local models and teams of agents. It doesn't mind which models you use or where they run, and a good harness is often what makes local models work well.

<Insert something specific about [Company] here: why this fits their work, what their team might use agents for, what hardware they have, and any earlier conversation. One short paragraph.>

What we propose:

1. **We install Swarm Map and configure the first set of agents.** We install Swarm Map on your hardware (or we can host it for you), connect it to Slack and selected repositories, and set up the first agents. Local models run where your machines allow, and hosted models (including open models run remotely) where you choose, each with its own spend cap. We pass on various best practices - for example, how to ensure that every code change is attributable to both a person and the agent.
2. **Guidance and handover.** We would provide some guidance on how to get the best value out of agentic AI. It's a different way of working, and we can pass on what we've learned. We would demonstrate how to monitor and 'govern' agents and their behaviour over time. Swarm Map and Hermes are both open source and built to be extended, so an agent that checks a data pipeline, runs an analysis notebook or drafts a report is something your team can build themselves.

<Optional: an example or experiment that would interest [Company]. For a research audience, for example, Matilde, an open-source Swarm Map agent that reads the literature, checks claims against Crossref and OpenAlex, and publishes its findings and corrections in the open.>

Cost. We propose a small fixed price of [NZD] for the install. It should take a couple of weeks of elapsed time, and we will work with your team until they are comfortable running and configuring it themselves. After that it's yours: the software is open source and the install stays with you to control. Local models cost nothing to run, and any hosted models are billed to your own account. An optional retainer of [NZD per month] keeps us on call for support, deployment of upgrades and future collaboration.

Who is NimbleCo? NimbleCo (https://nimbleco.ai) is the consulting wing of Cyborg Garden (https://cyborg.garden), a Wellington venture studio where people and AI agents work together, which runs all its own operations on Swarm Map. It was founded by Juniper Bevensee (https://juniperbevensee.com), an Edmund Hillary Fellow living in Wellington and the author of Swarm Map (https://github.com/cyborg-garden/swarm-map).

I'm Miles Thompson (https://goodbright.nz). I spent six years at Te Hiku Media on Māori speech recognition (https://papareo.io), and since then I've worked on agentic AI and governance. When I started on local agentic AI earlier this year, I was delighted to find an awesome local-AI-focused harness written right here in Wellington by Juni. Together we ran about thirty agents across two hardware setups, including fully local models on a Mac Studio, surfaced into Slack, Signal, WhatsApp and Mattermost.

We'd be delighted to talk this through, adjust it to suit, or demo a working install of Swarm Map.

Ngā mihi,

Miles Thompson, for NimbleCo

Notes to Juni (delete before sending).

How to use this template: make a copy, fill in everything in [square brackets], and replace each <…> section with a short paragraph about the company. Delete anything that doesn't fit.

Target: [Company] ([website])
has: [hardware, team, how they use AI now]
wants: [what they're after]

[Background on the relationship and how the conversation started.]

From you (Juni) we need:
- thoughts on "fixed price of [NZD]" - how much? How to estimate?
- thoughts on "two weeks" to install?
- a suggested minimum spec for running local models
- anything else?